

Fall 2025 CPTS530 Midterm Project
MATH 448-548
Numerical Analysis

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Problem 1

Problem Statement: Use Taylor theorem to derive the error term for the approximate formula

$$f'(x) \approx \frac{1}{2h}(-3f(x) + 4f(x+h) - f(x+2h)).$$

Solution:

We are given the finite-difference formula:

$$f'(x) \approx \frac{1}{2h} [-3f(x) + 4f(x+h) - f(x+2h)]$$

Expand $f(x+h)$ and $f(x+2h)$ about x using Taylor's theorem, keeping terms up to h^2 and representing higher-order terms as k_1h^3 and k_2h^4 :

$$\begin{aligned} f(x+h) &= f(x) + hf'(x) + \frac{h^2}{2}f''(x) + k_1h^3 \\ f(x+2h) &= f(x) + 2hf'(x) + 2h^2f''(x) + k_2h^3 \end{aligned}$$

where k_1, k_2 are finite constants depending on third order derivatives of f at x .

Substitute into the formula:

$$\begin{aligned} &\frac{1}{2h} [-3f(x) + 4f(x+h) - f(x+2h)] \\ &= \frac{1}{2h} \left[-3f(x) + 4 \left(f(x) + hf'(x) + \frac{h^2}{2}f''(x) + k_1h^3 \right) \right. \\ &\quad \left. - \left(f(x) + 2hf'(x) + 2h^2f''(x) + k_2h^3 \right) \right] \end{aligned}$$

Simplifying the terms in the square brackets:

$$= \frac{1}{2h} [2hf'(x) + (4k_1 - k_2)h^3]$$

Now, divide each term by $2h$:

$$= f'(x) + \frac{1}{2}(4k_1 - k_2)h^2$$

Thus, the leading error term is $O(h^2)$:

$$\text{error} \sim O(h^2)$$

This shows the method is second-order accurate. Note that I've already checked if the third order term vanishes if we write out the Taylor's polynomial to the third order, and it does not.

Problem 2

Problem Statement: Consider the following variation of the Newton's method:

$$x_{n+1} = x_n - \frac{f(x_n)}{f'(x_0)}.$$

Find constants C and s such that

$$e_{n+1} = C e_n^s.$$

Solution:

Problem 3

Problem Statement: Consider the linear system $\mathbf{Ax} = \mathbf{b}$, where

$$\mathbf{A} = \begin{bmatrix} 6.25 & -1 & 0.5 \\ -1 & 5 & 2.12 \\ 0.5 & 2.12 & 3.6 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{b} = \begin{bmatrix} 7.5 \\ -8.68 \\ -0.24 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Write a computer program for LU-factorization with a unit lower triangular $\mathbf{L}$ (meaning that the diagonal entries should be equal to one). Then write a program for the Cholesky factorization.

WARNING: avoid using shortcuts. The programming should be done "from scratch".

Solution:

Problem 4

Problem Statement: Consider the equation

$$f(x) = 0,$$

where

$$f(x) = x - \frac{1}{2} \left(\cos(x/2) - \left| x - \frac{1}{2} \right| \right).$$

Do the following.

Part 1

Rewrite the equation as a fixed point problem for a function $T(x)$ related to $f(x)$. Prove that $T(x)$ (i) maps the interval $[0.45, 0.55]$ into itself, and (ii) $T(x)$ is contractive on this interval. Based on the theorems in the books and notes, make conclusions about existence and uniqueness of a solution to $f(x) = 0$.

Solution:

Problem Statement: Consider the equation

$$f(x) = 0,$$

where

$$f(x) = x - \frac{1}{2} \left(\cos(x/2) - \left| x - \frac{1}{2} \right| \right).$$

Do the following.

Part 2

Write the computer program implementing the fixed point iteration $x_{n+1} = T(x_n)$. Discuss the choice of an initial guess x_0 . Calculate the solution to within 10 decimal places. Note the number of iterations needed.

Solution:

Problem Statement: Consider the equation

$$f(x) = 0,$$

where

$$f(x) = x - \frac{1}{2} \left(\cos(x/2) - \left| x - \frac{1}{2} \right| \right).$$

Do the following.

Part 3

Use a priori and a posteriori error estimates from the notes to estimate the number of iterations needed to obtain the above accuracy. Which estimate is more accurate?

Solution:

Problem Statement: Consider the equation

$$f(x) = 0,$$

where

$$f(x) = x - \frac{1}{2} \left(\cos(x/2) - \left| x - \frac{1}{2} \right| \right).$$

Do the following.

Part 4

Implement the Newton's method on a computer for the same equation starting with x_0 within the interval $[0.45, 0.55]$. Discuss the theoretical difficulty related to non-existence of $f'(x)$ for certain point(s) within the interval. How would you set up the Newton's method to resolve the problem?

Solution:

Problem Statement: Consider the equation

$$f(x) = 0,$$

where

$$f(x) = x - \frac{1}{2} \left(\cos(x/2) - \left| x - \frac{1}{2} \right| \right).$$

Do the following.

Part 5

Note the number of iterations needed to calculate the solution to within 10 decimal places using the Newton's method. Discuss the speed of convergence of the Newton's method and compare it with the convergence speed of the fixed point iterations.

Solution:

Problem Statement: Consider the equation

$$f(x) = 0,$$

where

$$f(x) = x - \frac{1}{2} \left(\cos(x/2) - \left| x - \frac{1}{2} \right| \right).$$

Do the following.

Part 6

Implement the alternative error control strategy proposed by you in HW 3, Problem 2. Compare the results with the ones obtained using a priori and a posteriori error estimates.

Solution:

Problem 5

Problem Statement: Implement and analyze the Ridders' method for solving the equation $f(x) = 0$. For guidance, you might wish to read the Wikipedia page on the Ridders' method. Also feel free to consult other sources.

Brief Description of the method

Given the initial bracketing interval $[x_0, x_2]$, containing **one** solution, and such that $f(x_0)$ and $f(x_2)$ have opposite signs, compute the midpoint $x_1 = (x_0 + x_2)/2$. Then define a new function $h(x) = f(x)e^{ax}$. Find the parameter a that ensures $h(x_1) = \frac{1}{2}(h(x_0) + h(x_2))$. Then define x_3 as the x -intercept of the line passing through $(x_0, h(x_0))$ and $(x_2, h(x_2))$. Use x_3 as one of the endpoints of the next interval bracketing the solution. The other endpoint is x_1 if $f(x_1)f(x_3) < 0$. Otherwise, choose either x_0 or x_2 based on the requirement that the sign of $f(x)$ at the chosen point must be opposite to the sign of $f(x_3)$. Continue until the desired accuracy is reached.

Part 1

Show that a is uniquely defined and give the equation for finding it.

Solution:

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Part 2

Work out a formula for x_3 in detail.

Solution:

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Part 3

Implement Ridders' method on a computer together with the standard bisection method for finding **all** solutions of

$$e^x - x^2 = 0.$$

Solution:

First I'll plot the graph of $e^x - x^2$ to identify the intervals where the function changes sign, indicating the presence of roots.

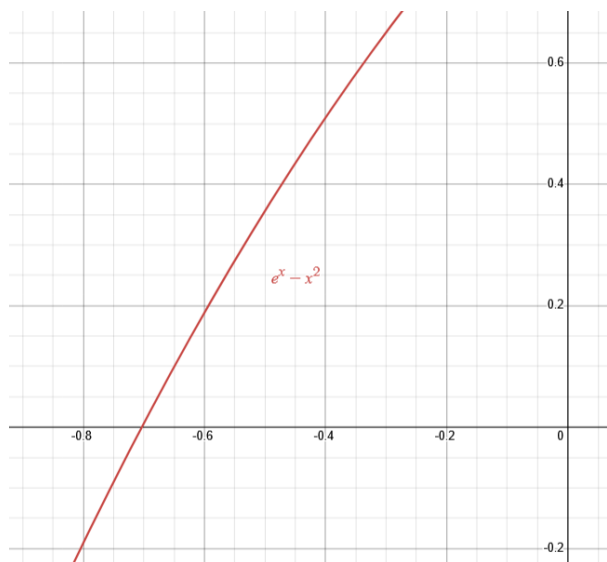


Figure 1: *
Zoomed in

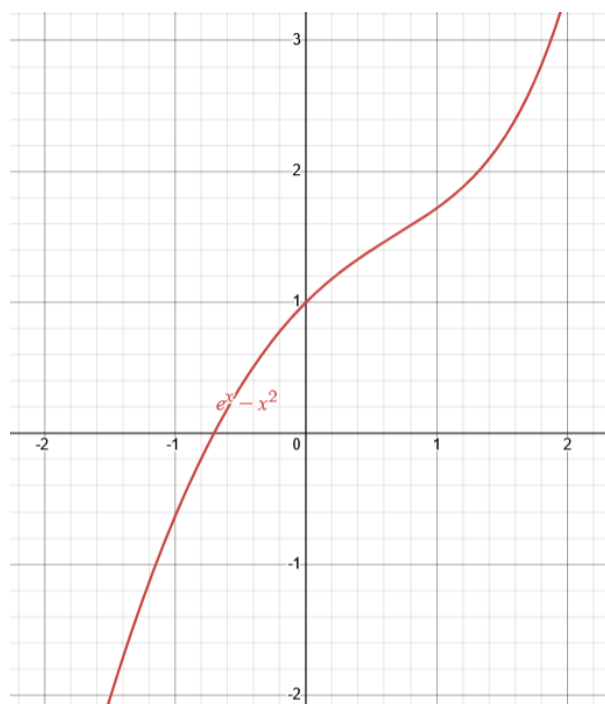


Figure 2: *
Zoomed out

Figure 3: Graphs of $e^x - x^2$: We can see from the zoomed in graph on the left that there is a single root in $[-0.8, -0.6]$. The zoomed out graph on the right shows the behavior of the function over a larger interval.

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Part 4

Numerically, compare the convergence rate of both algorithms. Discuss the results. What is the approximate order of convergence for the Ridders' algorithm?

Solution:
